

Field	Description
Case ID:	CS-2025-004
Case Type:	An active 'Ceprolad' malware in a command line was prevented from executing
Reported by:	Windows Defender
Analyst:	Ali YILMAZ
Date:	2025-10-16
Severity:	Medium
Status:	Closed
Environment:	Production

Case Title

An active 'Ceprolad' malware in a command line was prevented from executing

Case ID

4-Case – T1059.003 – Command and Scripting Interpreter: Windows Command Shell (Ceprolad Malware Execution Attempt)

Detection Source

- Microsoft Defender / endpoint protection (process/command-line blocked)
- **Short description:** An active Ceprolad (Trojan:Win32/Ceprolad.A / Behavior:Win32/Ceprolad.A) sample attempted to execute via command line but was prevented by endpoint protection. Ceprolad is a trojan that may gather system/network info and perform attacker-controlled actions

Incident Summary

Malware and unwanted software are undesirable applications that perform annoying, disruptive, or harmful actions on affected machines. Some of these undesirable applications can replicate and spread from one machine to another. Others are able to receive commands from remote attackers and perform activities associated with cyber attacks.

A malware is considered active if it is found running on the machine or it already has persistence mechanisms in place. Active malware detections are assigned higher severity ratings.

Because this malware was active, take precautionary measures and check for residual signs of infection.

MITRE ATT&CK

T1059 - Command and Scripting Interpreter (malicious command execution)

Investigation Steps

- Record detection timestamp, device name, username, and full ProcessCommandLine from the alert.
- Confirm whether anti-malware action was *blocked/quarantined/removed* in the alert metadata. (collect alert ActionType).
- Pull full EDR artifact: process tree (parent/child), image hashes, file path, registry autorun entries, network endpoints observed.
- Query for other devices with same file hash, file name, or process command line in the last 7 days.
- Check whether certutil / other signed system utilities were invoked (some Cephrolad detections have triggered on certutil-like activity — consider false-positive context)

Evidence

- Screenshot of the Defender alert (showing threat name, action, timestamp).
- Exported alert JSON or CSV with ProcessCommandLine and DeviceID.
- Process tree screenshot or event log snippet.
- File hash (MD5/SHA256) and file path.

Recommended Actions

- Isolate the affected endpoint from network (if allowed by policy).
- Collect and upload EDR artifacts (process event, driver logs, associated files).
- Run full antimalware scan + export scan results. [Microsoft](#)
- Block detected file hash and any known C2 domains/IPs at endpoint protection and perimeter (if present).
- Change credentials for the impacted user(s) if there is evidence of credential theft or suspicious logins.
- Notify Tier-2/IR team with artifacts and isolation status.

Organizational / HR Actions

- If user interaction suspected (phishing/email), inform Security Awareness team and consider targeted user coaching.
- If data exfiltration suspected, escalate to IR and Legal for data-breach evaluation.

Business Impact

The “Ceprolad” malware, if executed, could have compromised system integrity by modifying Windows core processes and collecting sensitive configuration data. Since the threat was **blocked before execution**, no data loss or persistence was observed. Impact is therefore **Medium**, limited to an attempted malware execution event. No business interruption, lateral movement, or user credential compromise occurred.

Quick Hunting Snippets

DeviceEvents

| where ActionType == "AntivirusDetection"

| where AdditionalFields has_cs "Ceprolad" or ThreatName has_cs "Ceprolad"

| project Timestamp, DeviceName, ThreatName, FileName, FileHash, ActionTaken

Result / Assessment

- Classification: True Positive — Malware execution attempt (Behavior: Win32/Ceprolad.A).
Command-line attempt to execute Ceprolad was detected and blocked by EDR/AV.
Confidence: High.
- Summary: On 15 October 2025, an attempt to launch Ceprolad via a command-line process was observed; the process spawn was prevented and malicious behavior was blocked.
- Scope: Currently appears limited to a single host. No evidence of lateral movement or additional hosts impacted.
- Impact: Low — execution prevented; no observed data loss, persistence, or credential compromise.
- Evidence: EDR/AV block alert, process creation/block logs, relevant event IDs and alert record support the finding.
- Risk assessment: Immediate operational risk is low, but there is residual risk of repeat attempts or variant activity. Monitoring should continue.
- Status / Containment decision: Contained — Remediation required. Closure criteria:
- Full host malware scan shows clean results.
- All related IOCs are blocked/blacklisted in EDR and network controls.

- SIEM/EDR hunting shows no re-occurrence for 7 consecutive days.
- Analyst note: High-confidence true positive that was successfully mitigated.
Recommend follow-up host forensic scan and short-term elevated monitoring.

Incidents > An active 'Ceprolad' malware in a command line was prevented from executing

An active 'Ceprolad' malware in a command line was prevent...

[Manage incident](#) [Tasks](#) [...](#)

Medium Resolved Musa.Karakaya@csvisor.de malware

Go Hunt queries launched from the entity menu now default to a time range starting from the incident's start time up to the execution time. For incidents older than 30 days, the query defaults to last 30-day.

Attack story Alerts (1) Assets (2) Investigations (1) Evidence and Response (1) Summary

Incident graph Layout Group similar nodes

Communication Association

Incident description

Malware and unwanted software are undesirable applications that perform annoying, disruptive, or harmful actions on affected machines. Some of these undesirable applications can replicate and spread from one machine to another. Others are able to receive commands from remote attackers and perform activities associated with cyber attacks. A malware is considered active if it is found running on the machine or it already has persistence mechanisms in place. Active malware detections are assigned higher severity ratings. Because this malware was active, take precautionary measures and check for residual signs of infection. [See less](#)

Impacted assets

Devices (1)	Risk Level	Exposure Level
DESKTOP-04...	None	Medium

Users (1)

Incidents > An active 'Ceprolad' malware in a command line was prevented from executing > An active 'Ceprolad' malware in a command line was prevented from executing



An active 'Ceprolad' malware in a command line was p...

[Comments \(0\)](#)

Investigation #27 is complete - No threats found

Investigation graph Alerts (1) Devices (1) Evidence (1) Entities (1.91k) Log (28)

Investigation Summary

Investigation Status Timeline

Started
Oct 15, 2025 3:22 PM

Ended
Oct 15, 2025 4:06 PM

Duration
44:46m

Investigation details

Status
No threats found

Alert severity
Low

Category
Malware

Detection source
Antivirus

Device (1)
DESKTOP-04LC16L

Entities analyzed (1910)
822 Files
106 Processes
284 Services
420 Drivers
5 IP Addresses
273 Persistence Methods

Alert received
An active 'Ceprolad' malware in a command line was prevented fr...

Evidence
1 entity found

Result
No threats found

An active 'Ceprolad' malware in a command line was prevent...

[Manage incident](#) [Tasks](#) ...

Medium Resolved Musa.Karakaya@cvsior.de malware

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[Attack story](#) Alerts (1) Assets (2) Investigations (1) Evidence and Response (1) Summary[Incident graph](#) Layout Group similar nodes

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Musa.Karakaya@cvsior.de

Microsoft Defender

Advanced hunting

Selected workspace: mssentinel Help resources

New query* +

Schema Functions

Search

Run query Last 7 days Save Share link Create summary rule

Query

```
1 DeviceProcessEvents
2 | where ProcessCommandLine contains "Ceprolad"
3 | or ProcessCommandLine contains ".exe"
4 | or InitiatingProcessCommandLine contains "Ceprolad"
5 | project Timestamp, DeviceName, ProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessComm
6 | order by Timestamp desc
```

Getting started Results Query history

Export 45972 items Search 00:04:211 Low

Filters: Add filter

Timestamp	DeviceName	ProcessCommandLine	InitiatingProcessFileName	InitiatingProcessCon
Oct 15, 2025 5:13:...	dedcs-01	smartscreen.exe -Embed...	svchost.exe	svchost.exe -k Dc...
Oct 15, 2025 5:13:...	dedcs-01	conhost.exe 0x0fffff -Fo...	sdbinst.exe	sdbinst.exe -m -b...
Oct 15, 2025 5:13:...	dedcs-01	sdbinst.exe -m -bg	svchost.exe	svchost.exe -k Loc...

badf4752413cb0cbdc03fb95820ca167f0cdc63b597ccdb5ef43111180e088b0

0
/ 72

Community Score -87

No security vendors flagged this file as malicious

Reanalyze Similar More

badf4752413cb0cbdc03fb95820ca167f0cdc63b597ccdb5ef43111180e088b0

Size 283.00 KB

Last Analysis Date 1 hour ago

EXE

peexe detect-debug-environment known-distributor legit 64bits idle

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

BEHAVIOR

COMMUNITY 27+

Contained in Graphs (7)

LilyVT

APT-C-29

2025-10-14 10:29:59

miniuser

taskhostw.exe reserved IPss

2025-03-30 11:24:53

oneill

BenJammin

2025-03-07 20:16:33

hammond_of_texas

Copy of Lets Go Camping

2025-03-03 13:25:33

hammond_of_texas

Lets Go Camping

2025-02-28 15:26:55

DjHumildeDev

Pen drive suspicious :D

2024-12-17 13:08:01

DjHumildeDev

Pen drive suspicious :D

2024-12-17 13:07:59

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ATT&CKcon 6.0 is coming October 14-15 in McLean, VA and live online. Tickets are available now!

TECHNIQUES

Windows Command Shell

Unix Shell

Visual Basic

Python

JavaScript

Network Device CLI

Cloud API

AutoHotKey & AutoIT

Lua

Hypervisor CLI

Container Administration

Command

Deploy Container

ESXi Administration

Home > Techniques > Enterprise > Command and Scripting Interpreter > Windows Command Shell

Command and Scripting Interpreter: Windows Command Shell

Other sub-techniques of Command and Scripting Interpreter (12)

Adversaries may abuse the Windows command shell for execution. The Windows command shell (cmd) is the primary command prompt on Windows systems. The Windows command prompt can be used to control almost any aspect of a system, with various permission levels required for different subsets of commands. The command prompt can be invoked remotely via Remote Services such as SSH.^[1]

Batch files (ex. .bat or .cmd) also provide the shell with a list of sequential commands to run, as well as normal scripting operations such as conditionals and loops. Common uses of batch files include long or repetitive tasks, or the need to run the same set of commands on multiple systems.

Adversaries may leverage cmd to execute various commands and payloads. Common uses include cmd to execute a single command, or abusing cmd interactively with input and output forwarded over a command and control channel.

ID: T1059.003

Sub-technique of: T1059

Tactic: Execution

Platforms: Windows

Version: 1.5

Created: 09 March 2020

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Version Permalink